

Scribl x Bounteous

Date July 14, 2026 **Format** Working session, collaboration board & live prototype demo

Prepared by Bounteous for Scribl

At a glance

The kickoff workshop did what we hoped it would: it aligned both teams on a shared product direction, mapped the launch scope end to end, and earned strong conviction in the prototype. Both founders closed the session committed to moving forward together.

"I would be out pitching this tomorrow with what you showed us today."

— Matt Kaplan, CEO

"We've been waiting 20 years for this. Let's go."

— Jeff Sparr, CRO

The most important outcome was a shared decision to re-anchor the timeline. The earlier placeholder dates came off the table, and the room set its sights on the **AWS re:Invent keynote (~December 5, 2026)** as the aspirational proof point, with beta and public-launch dates to be set by product readiness once Scribl completes its internal planning sync.

Three things to carry forward:

- **The timeline is now re:Invent-anchored and readiness-driven.** Beta, public launch, and first-submission dates are intentionally left open until Scribl's internal

sync.

- **Claude moves to the center of the product experience.** The room chose to make Claude a visible, meaningful part of the beta because it makes the product more personal, more reflective, and more delightful for users.
- **The prototype is the seed of the production app.** The demo is a real starting point the team continues from, and it grew live during the session as ideas landed.

1. North Star

Direction is locked; final wording is a short pass away. The room agreed the bet is **connection**, and that **simplicity** is the essence that has to live in the statement.

"Without that word simple, it's missing the essence."

— Jeff Sparr

The three finalist statements the room voted up:

TYPE	STATEMENT
We win when	"We win when users connect with the people in their lives who matter most."
Billboard	"Draw something simple. Discover something real."
Product is	"Scribl empowers you to connect authentically with those that matter most across distance, schedules, and generations."

Matt favored centering the individual: an empowering, personal experience is the fuel for adoption and word-of-mouth growth. The next step is a short working pass with Helen to fold "simple" into the winning frame.

2. The eight key decisions

Every decision card was worked through and confirmed in the room. Each is shown with the call and the reasoning behind it.

#	DECISION	THE CALL	WHY
1	Voice memo response	Fast-follow after the first release. Typed story text stays in for both platforms from the start.	Typing covers the core experience and keeps the critical path light; voice returns in the first post-launch sprint without rework.
2	Paywall timing	Post-launch.	The beta gathers the cleanest possible engagement data; run-cost and per-artifact cost are still unknown, so pricing waits until the data is in.
3	Personalized follow-ups	The real, memory-aware version lands after the first release; the plumbing is built in from the start. Generic and event-based nudges ("Matt just drew on your wall") carry the interim.	Build the foundation early, then switch on true personalization once enough user history exists to make it feel earned.
4	Age gate (minors / COPPA)	Ship 13+ first for beta and public launch. Pursue an under-13 experience as a separate submission after launch, with in-app "coming soon" messaging for younger users.	This protects the re:Invent window: Apple's minor-protection rules and COPPA add material review time and reporting. The 8–12 family segment is the acknowledged sweet spot and is a deliberate fast follow, not a drop.
5	Moderation fail policy	Fail-safe: hold submissions if moderation is ever unavailable. A richer graceful-degradation experience comes later.	"If we're going to fail, let's fail safe." Outages are rare, and early users tolerate a brief hold far better than a moderation miss.

#	DECISION	THE CALL	WHY
6	Claude integration depth	Claude is a visible differentiator from beta: personalized, context-aware prompts, a drawing reflection, and an empathy-oriented experience.	A meaningful Claude presence makes the product more personal and more delightful, and it is a large part of what makes Scribl feel unlike anything else.
7	Partner API "at launch"	Post-launch; Scribl updates the PRFAQ accordingly.	There is no build stream for the API today, and the PRFAQ is a working draft.
8	Channel model	A fixed set of predefined, renamable channels for the first release, tagged by wall type (family / friends / coworkers). Unlimited channels become a premium feature.	Predefined channels keep measurement consistent; the room's instinct converged near three (personal, family, friends), with the exact count to be finalized.

A note on decision 4. The deferral of the under-13 experience is a timeline decision, not a change of heart. The 8–12 family sweet spot remains a priority target and is planned as a fast follow. The team will research whether Apple's parental-approval ("ask-to-buy") flow could support an under-13 experience sooner.

One product principle beyond the list: comments are out. The room's shared aversion to social-media negativity became a design decision — comments were removed from the product live during the demo. A future idea worth keeping: reactions expressed as drawings or emoji rather than text.

3. Feature map

Where the room placed each capability across the three phases.

BETA — PROVES THE DAILY HABIT LOOP

- Core drawing canvas: fill bucket, brush sizes, color palette
- Typed story text (both platforms)
- AI background enhancement, with an on/off toggle in settings
- Daily prompt delivery and challenges
- Streaks, milestones, badges; archives / timeline view; draw-your-own avatars
- Fixed channels (count to be finalized) with wall-type tags; submit-to-unlock
- Content moderation (fail-safe)
- **Meaningful Claude features** — personalized prompts and drawing reflection
- Compliance gates: 13+ age gate, report button, block/mute, privacy labels
- **Accessible analytics and reporting for Scribl staff** (raised as a hard requirement)

BY LAUNCH — POLISH AND STORE READINESS

- Share submissions to social media (a shareable image plus a branded link to a "coming soon" page)
- Export tools and printables; custom / renamable channel names
- Organizing and reusing custom prompts (heavily used on Scribl today)
- Notification preferences and quiet hours
- Store listings, screenshots, review notes; channel-isolation and load tests as a launch gate
- AI-consent surface, in-app deletion, AI-content labels, ToS acceptance, support contact

POST-LAUNCH — FAST FOLLOWS AND EXPANSION

- Voice memo and Android dictation (fast-follow)
- Premium paywall and unlimited archives
- Under-13 experience (separate submission)
- Partner API

- Theme packs, custom props, unlockables and progression rewards, sticker store
- The **Exciting Artifact** (combine chosen pieces into a shareable family collage)
- Slack / Teams, SSO, enterprise admin dashboards, localization, SOC 2

WHAT MOVED DURING THE SESSION

FEATURE	FROM	TO	WHY
Voice memo	Implied beta	Post-launch fast-follow	Typing covers the core loop; Android device variance
Social sharing	Beta candidate	By launch	A growth lever worth polishing for launch
Enterprise / high-capacity walls	Post-launch	Solution now, plan for re:Invent	A large event could mean very high concurrent submissions
Comments	Shown in demo	Removed	Negativity and social-comparison risk
Notification prefs / quiet hours	Unscoped	By launch	Partly covered by OS-level controls

4. Notable product themes

- **The timeline is now readiness-driven.** With placeholder dates retired, the plan anchors on re:Invent (~Dec 5) and works backward, which relieves the artificial compression pressure that shaped some earlier recommendations.
- **Claude ambition rose deliberately.** The room wants Claude central in beta — personalized, context-aware prompts (Eric's "favorite ride at Epcot" example) and a psychology-informed, empathy-oriented experience — because it makes the product genuinely more personal and more delightful for users.

- **Enterprise event mode pulled forward** to be solutioned for re:Invent, reframed as high-capacity walls for organizations. A past experience degraded around 50–60 participants, so scaling is a real design focus.
- **Analytics accessibility is a hard requirement.** Scribl struggles to parse its own data today — "the bane of my existence," in Eric's words. Reporting that Scribl staff can actually use must be ready at launch.
- **Scribl's own visual style should flavor AI output.** The AI enhancement should feel like Scribl ("scribbly clouds," not a Renaissance field); Scribl will supply reference art to tune it.
- **The prototype grew live.** As ideas landed mid-session, draw-your-own avatars, more brushes and colors, and an archives "yesterday" view were added on the spot, and comments were removed.

5. Risks we solve together



Every risk below is a shared challenge with a clear path forward. Naming them early is how we protect the timeline.

RISK	WHAT IT COULD MEAN	HOW WE ADDRESS IT
App Store review for a UGC + AI + social category	Longer review, more reporting, higher rejection odds	13+-first posture lowers the risk; engage Apple developer relations early in Phase 0
COPPA / minors timing	Under-13 adds review time	Ship 13+ first; pursue under-13 as a separate submission; research ask-to-buy mitigation
Cross-platform device coverage	Voice/speech features may vary on older Android devices	Keep voice a post-launch fast-follow; validate device coverage in beta

RISK	WHAT IT COULD MEAN	HOW WE ADDRESS IT
Scale at re:Invent	High concurrent load is unproven at event scale	Solution high-capacity walls now; channel-isolation and load tests as a launch gate
Cost and pricing uncertainty	Blocks the pricing model	Gather run-cost and artifact-cost data in beta before setting the paywall
Analytics accessibility	Scribl can't parse its own usage today	Build accessible reporting for Scribl staff, targeted for beta

6. Next steps and the path forward

The room agreed a clear, low-friction path into the engagement:

1. **This readout** — Bounteous synthesizes the workshop (this document).
2. **Proposal** — Bounteous delivers a high-level proposal.
3. **MSA** — John Kilgore starts the Master Services Agreement now, so Scribl's legal team has runway to review in parallel.
4. **SOW** — the Statement of Work and staffing plan are prepared at Phase 0 kickoff.
5. **AWS alignment** — Bounteous applies for AWS funding on Scribl's behalf and coordinates a three-way AWS + Scribl + Bounteous alignment call to de-risk the build.
6. **Dates** — beta, public-launch, and first-submission dates are stamped once Scribl completes its internal sync.

A few near-term items the teams own together:

- **Scribl:** complete the internal planning sync so dates can be set; update the PRFAQ (dates, partner API, scope); name a moderation-queue owner before the first beta user; supply Scribl-branded reference art to tune AI output.
- **Bounteous:** deliver the proposal; start the MSA; build accessible analytics for Scribl staff; solution high-capacity walls for re:Invent; research Apple's parental-approval flow for

under-13.

- **Together:** finish the North Star wording with Helen; hold the three-way AWS alignment call; finalize the exact channel count.

Funding partnerships already in motion with AWS — and the Claude-centered product direction — help de-risk Scribl's build and strengthen the story going into re:Invent.

Who was in the room

SCRIBL	BOUNTEOUS
Matt Kaplan — CEO	Angie Yap — SVP, Alliances (facilitator)
Jeff Sparr — CRO	David Lawton — SVP, Data & AI
Eric Rice — CCO	Marty Young — EVP, Data & AI
Helen Leffers — Chief of Staff	Rob Forshier II — Sr. Principal
Abbie Knapton — Customer Experience Lead	John Kilgore — VP, Client Service

Voices from the room

More than anything, the workshop earned conviction. These are the words the Scribl team used, unprompted, as the product direction and the working prototype came together in front of them.

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"I would be out pitching this tomorrow with what you showed us today."

Matt Kaplan — CEO

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"We've been waiting 20 years for this. Let's go."

Jeff Sparr — CRO

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"This is brilliant. I'm blown away — the fact that you scraped our website, got some inputs, and this is what you built. I'm thrilled. I can't even imagine where we can take this."

Matt Kaplan — CEO

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"That's truly incredible. It's so weird seeing the wireframe come to life and actually work."

Eric Rice — CCO

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"The most fun thing about this is we can riff on it all day. Anybody that sees it has a new idea, thinks of something to add to it. We've got a really good foundation and we can build some really fun stuff. So it's exciting."

Eric Rice — CCO

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"I'm really, really excited to see it coming back to that family element."

Eric Rice — CCO

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"It was really, really impressive, and super excited about the opportunity to partner together."

Matt Kaplan — CEO



"Seriously, this is going to be great."

Abbie Knapton — Customer Experience Lead

This readout is the durable record of the July 14, 2026 kickoff workshop. Final North Star wording, launch dates, and commercial terms are being finalized as noted above.